

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Gireesh Giraddi

Address: 26 Matlock Crescent Cheam SM3 9SP

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Formal Objection - Former Sutton Ambulance Station, Dorset Road

I strongly object to the proposed high-capacity place of worship and community hub at the former Sutton Ambulance Station. The scale, intensity, and operating hours of this development are wholly inappropriate for a 100% residential area and would cause significant and lasting harm to highway safety, parking, residential amenity, and neighbourhood character.

Traffic and Highway Safety

The applicant's own documents state that up to 250 people may arrive and leave within a short period around Friday prayers. This concentrated peak would generate a substantial traffic surge on a quiet residential street not designed to accommodate such volumes. Increased vehicle movements, turning, and circulation will materially compromise highway safety.

Severe Parking Shortfall

Only 14 on-site parking spaces are proposed. The applicant acknowledges that up to 69 cars may overspill onto surrounding roads, with approximately 80 vehicles present locally during overlap periods. This level of on-street parking demand will inevitably result in blocked driveways, unsafe corner parking, reduced visibility, and restricted emergency access. The surrounding streets do not have the capacity to absorb this additional pressure.

School Safety Risk

Avenue Primary School has approximately 1,000 pupils. Additional traffic and parking congestion during peak periods will heighten risks to children at drop-off and pick-up times. Road safety

around a large primary school must be a primary consideration.

Late-Night Disturbance

Dispersal of large numbers of people at around 11pm will cause engine noise, doors slamming, raised voices, and vehicles circulating in search of parking. This level of late-evening activity is incompatible with a quiet suburban neighbourhood and would significantly harm residential amenity and sleep.

Impact on Vulnerable Residents

A nearby care home and elderly residents will be particularly affected by obstruction and late-night disturbance. The proposal does not demonstrate how these impacts will be mitigated.

Incompatible and Over-Intensive Use

This is a purely residential area of homes and gardens. Introducing a high-turnover, long-hours community facility represents a fundamental and permanent change to the character of the neighbourhood. The proposed extensions and increased height would also create a building out of keeping with the domestic scale of surrounding properties.

No Demonstrated Unmet Need and Cumulative Impact

Multiple similar facilities exist within 1-1.5 miles. There is no clear evidence of unmet demand justifying such an intensive use in a location with poor public transport accessibility (PTAL 1a). Dorset Road and surrounding streets already experience congestion and parking pressure; this proposal would significantly worsen cumulative impacts.

Conclusion

The development is excessive, unjustified, and harmful. It would materially compromise highway safety, create unacceptable parking pressure, increase risks to school children, generate late-night disturbance, and permanently alter the residential character of the area.

For these reasons, I respectfully request that planning permission be refused.